

after many attempts I am unable to install Windows 98.

After a couple of reboots, it starts executing scanreg and then hangs. When I boot the system with a bootable floppy, scandisk gives an error saying, "Some of Windows files have been allocated to invalid partitions/locations," and a prompt such as 'Fix it' or 'Don't Fix It'. Even after I choose 'Fix It', the problem isn't resolved. What do I do?

Amit Gupta

A There are only two possibilities—either the RAM or the hard disk is faulty. As a first step, get a working RAM module from a friend's PC and try the installation. If it works, just get new RAM. If it doesn't, then get the hard disk checked thoroughly at a service centre.

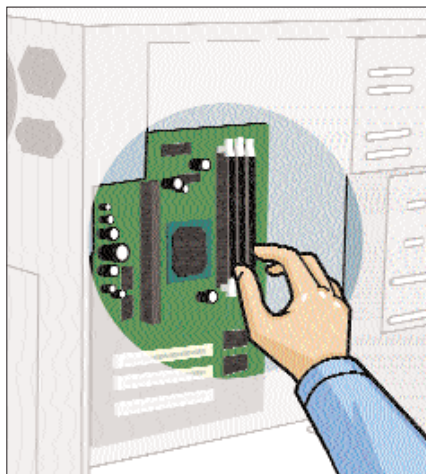
Can't find root

Q. I am totally new to Linux. Whenever I try to install PCQ Linux 2004, I get an error saying the root partition is not defined. What is a root partition? I have an 80 GB Samsung hard disk with four FAT32 partitions: The C: drive is 10.7 GB, and has Windows XP installed. The D: drive is 11 GB, E: is 28 GB and F: is 26 GB.

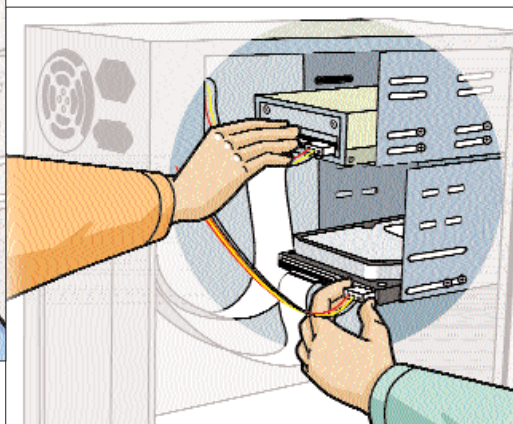
I want to install PCQ Linux 2004 on the D: drive with the dual-boot option.

Ashish Jha

A While installing Linux, you need to create the 'ext3' and swap partitions. At this point of time, specify the mount point for the ext3 partition as '/', without the quotes. You won't get the error message.



Make sure all connections and modules are tightly fitted



Where is my display?

Q. I have a Pentium 4 system with dual-boot, i.e., Windows 98 SE and Windows XP. In Windows 98, I right-clicked on the desktop and changed the resolution. Now my computer does not show up the display in Windows, and instead shows up the message 'Out of frequency'. What's the problem?

Where I can find details about files such as boot.ini, io.sys, config.sys and autoexec.bat?

Bikrant Rana

A To set the display right, boot into Windows 98's Safe Mode, by pressing [F8] while Windows is just about to start. In safe



mode, change the resolution to a lower one such as 640 x 480, and then restart the computer. As far as information about Windows files is concerned, visit www.support.microsoft.com, and search for the specific file details you need.

Hangs at power on

Q. My PC just doesn't boot. What I mean is that the PC starts normally, I can hear a single beep, then the PC shows the system configuration, then, 'updating ESCD', and that's it—nothing on the screen after that. A cursor blinks but the OS doesn't start. I had Windows 98 on my machine.

Afiya

A If you are well versed in PC hardware, open the cabinet and tighten the connections: the hard disk and CD-ROM connectors, etc. Press the RAM module gently. Also, verify the boot sequence in the BIOS; the first in the list should be the hard disk. Finally, use a boot floppy and check the partition table using 'fdisk' for irregularities; a bad partition table can cause such prob-

lems. If 'fdisk' does not give an error, call an engineer.

Is CD NTFS or FAT?

Q. I downloaded data from the Internet on a machine running Windows 2000/NTFS, and burned it on a CD. My home PC runs Windows 98/FAT, so naturally it's unable to see the CD files, and hangs. Is there any software available to view or extract the files from the CD and convert them to FAT?

Some Niyogi

A CDs have a file system of their own—CDFS. It does not matter if the host file system is NTFS or FAT. If the CD was created successfully without any errors, it should be read in Windows 98 too. A weak lens might be the culprit, but to verify this, just reading the CD in another drive using Windows 98. If the CD works, then the drive is faulty.

What is HyperThreading?

Q. I would like to know what HyperThreading is. I have heard a lot about this new product from Intel. I have an assembled PC that comprises an Intel D845GBV2 motherboard (which has an external AGP slot and Extreme Graphics onboard as well), an Intel 1.7 GHz, 512 MB RAM and a 80 GB Seagate Barracuda hard disk.

I would like to exchange my current motherboard for Intel's new Hyper-